

AI on Video Advertising: What It Can Do, and What It Still Can't

“The future of AI is not about replacing humans, it's about augmenting human capabilities”

— Sunder Pichai, CEO of Google



In video advertising, decisions are often made quickly and forgotten just as fast. Elements in ads be it a colour choice, a headline tweak, length of a shot, or the pacing of an edit, choice of background music or timing of a joke are constantly tested, revised and replaced. Video ads are designed for speed, performance and short attention spans.

It is within this fast-paced advertising ecosystem that we must situate Artificial Intelligence, one of the most powerful and disruptive entrants the industry has encountered so far. With the rise of AI tools in video marketing, advertisers are increasingly relying on automation to streamline production, improve performance, and scale content across platforms. But along with it there are many emerging risks, like creative homogenisation, where video ads are optimised for efficiency and scale at the cost of originality, narrative depth, and brand distinctiveness.

As AI tools become more deeply embedded in video advertising workflows, the question is no longer whether AI will be used, but how— and to what extent its capabilities are being overstated. This blog looks at what AI genuinely does well in advertising, where it falls short, and where its use becomes more about signalling innovation than creating it.

What AI Does Well in Video Advertising

Without a doubt, AI has improved advertisement and marketing industries in terms of speed, scale, and efficiency. In an ecosystem where platforms demand constant content refreshes and multiple format variations, AI-powered tools help advertisers keep up with the volume and speed required by clients.

One of the most visible contributions of AI in video advertising lies in automated production workflows. Tasks that once required long editing cycles, such as trimming footage, adjusting aspect ratios, generating captions, or creating multiple versions of the same ad, can now be handled rapidly through AI-assisted software. Tools like Adobe Sensei streamline post-production by automating colour correction, object selection, audio clean-up, and even rough cuts, allowing creative teams to focus their time on refining narratives rather than managing repetitive edits.

AI has also significantly improved the scalability of video ads across platforms. Social media ecosystems such as short-form vertical video, in-stream ads, and mobile-first placements require constant adaptation of the same creative idea into multiple formats. AI tools can automatically resize, reframe, and re-edit a single video asset into platform-specific versions without manually rebuilding each one. This capability has become especially valuable for performance-driven campaigns that run simultaneously across Instagram, YouTube, and TikTok.

Another area where AI adds tangible value is rapid content generation for low-stakes or functional video formats. Explainer videos, product demos, onboarding content, and internal communications are increasingly produced using AI-driven platforms such as Synthesia. These tools enable brands to generate presentable, consistent videos without traditional

shoots, making them particularly effective for corporate communication and instructional advertising formats where clarity matters more than emotional storytelling.



AI is also widely used in short-form video marketing, especially for social ads that prioritise speed and experimentation. Platforms like Pictory allow marketers to convert text-based content, blogs, scripts, or product descriptions, into quick video assets optimised for social feeds. While these videos may not redefine creative boundaries, they serve a clear functional purpose in maintaining content volume and brand visibility in crowded digital spaces.

Beyond production, AI plays a crucial role in creative optimisation and performance testing. Video advertising increasingly relies on testing multiple variations of the same ad to determine what performs best across different audiences. AI systems can generate and analyse multiple creative combinations, changing hooks, captions, thumbnails, or calls to action, while tracking engagement metrics in real time. This allows advertisers to refine video ads based on data rather than intuition alone.

Importantly, AI also enhances accessibility and inclusivity in video advertising. Automated captioning, voiceovers, translations, and audio descriptions make video ads more accessible across languages and abilities. These features expand reach while reducing the additional costs and time traditionally associated with localisation and compliance.

However, these strengths also highlight the boundaries of AI's role, boundaries that become more visible when advertising moves beyond execution into the realms of originality, cultural insight, and creative risk.

Where AI Falls Short



While AI has proven effective in accelerating production and optimisation, its limitations become most visible when video advertising demands emotional coherence, cultural sensitivity, and narrative intent. These are precisely the areas where advertising moves beyond execution and into meaning-making, an arena where AI continues to struggle.

Video ads often rely on emotional cues: warmth, nostalgia, humour, tension, to create memorability and brand affinity. AI systems can replicate the surface elements associated with these emotions, but they frequently fail to generate the emotional experience itself. The result is video ads that appear technically polished yet feel strangely hollow.

A recent festive campaign by Coca-Cola illustrates this gap. The ad leaned heavily on AI-generated visuals to recreate familiar seasonal imagery tied to the brand's long advertising legacy. While recognisable symbols were present, audience reactions suggested that the ad lacked the warmth and emotional continuity viewers associate with the brand's holiday storytelling. The issue was not technological failure, but emotional dissonance, AI reproduced the look of sentiment without its substance.

Video advertising does not operate independently of time, place, or cultural mood. Successful ads often hinge on timing, social awareness, and shared cultural reference points, areas where AI lacks lived experience. For instance, AI-generated video ads attempting to capitalise on festivals, social movements, or regional aesthetics often default to generic visual shorthand. Without human judgment, these ads risk appearing tone-deaf, overly safe, or misaligned with audience sentiment. Even when AI-produced ads avoid outright controversy, they may still fail quietly by missing the emotional register audiences expect, leading to disengagement rather than backlash.

At a structural level, AI's creative limitations stem from its dependence on existing data. Generative models learn by identifying and recombining patterns from past content. In video advertising, this often leads to aesthetic repetition, ads that resemble what has already worked, rather than introducing something new.

This is particularly problematic for brand-building video ads, where distinctiveness matters more than efficiency. When multiple brands use similar AI tools trained on overlapping datasets, the resulting ads risk blending into a homogenous visual culture: familiar transitions, predictable pacing, and interchangeable storytelling cues.

In such cases, AI does not fail technically: it succeeds too well at optimisation, at the cost of originality.

Conclusion: Toward a Hybrid Future of Video Advertising

The growing presence of Artificial Intelligence in video advertising has made one thing clear: AI is neither a creative saviour nor a creative threat in itself. Its real impact depends on **how and where it is used**. As this blog has shown, AI performs exceptionally well when deployed for execution, optimisation, and scale, but falls short when it is expected to generate emotional depth, cultural insight, or original storytelling on its own.



The most effective future of video advertising, therefore, lies not in full automation, but in **hybrid creative models**, where AI supports human creativity rather than attempting to replace it. This is where forward-looking agencies are beginning to redefine how AI fits into advertising workflows.

Agencies such as Enso 8 offer a useful example of this balanced approach. Instead of positioning AI as a shortcut to creativity, we integrate it as a collaborative tool, using AI to enhance production efficiency, creative testing, and performance optimisation, while retaining human control over ideation, storytelling, and brand voice. In doing so, we bridge

the gap between technological capability and creative intent, allowing video ads to remain emotionally resonant while benefiting from AI-driven precision.

This model recognises a crucial distinction often lost in AI hype: **advertising effectiveness is not defined by automation alone**. Video ads succeed when they connect, persuade, and remain culturally legible over time, outcomes that still depend heavily on human judgment. AI strengthens this process when it is embedded thoughtfully within creative ecosystems, not when it becomes the centrepiece of the narrative.

As AI tools continue to evolve, the challenge for advertisers and agencies will not be about adopting AI faster, but about adopting it **more responsibly and strategically**. The question is no longer whether AI belongs in video advertising, but how to ensure it is used in ways that add genuine value rather than perform innovation for its own sake.

At the same time, it is important to recognise that this moment represents only the early stages of AI's integration into video advertising. As generative models evolve, and as they are trained with greater contextual sensitivity and creative intent, some of the current limitations may well be addressed. What feels constrained or experimental today could become more intuitive, responsive, and collaborative tomorrow. For agencies like Enso 8, this is not an endpoint but a beginning, an opportunity to shape how AI grows alongside human creativity. The task ahead is not to predict a fully automated future, but to actively design one where technology and creative intelligence develop together. In that sense, the future of video advertising is not AI versus creativity, but AI and creativity working together, each doing what it does best.